ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals, Twin Melodies; A Friend Found in Music, Carrier of Words; Words (poem), Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** inspire action in readers	Purpose.
2	**(a)** once defied tradition himself yet resists his daughter	Repeating pattern.
3	**(c)** essential public services depend on ordinary people's dedication	Thematic argument.
4	**(b)** dreams are earned through sustained commitment and help from others	Central.
5	**(d)** a story makes values memorable	Narrative.
6	**(b)** He fears fusion will dilute his life's work	Inferred motive.
7	**(a)** grow into consequences	Consequence.
8	**(b)** safety may cost us growth	Interpretation.
9	**(c)** If she had given up, she would not have won the medal.	Had + would have.
10	**(b)** Fusion was never allowed in their house.	Was allowed.
11	**(d)** Letters are delivered even in the harshest heat.	Are delivered.
12	**(c)** Having counted the cost, Ming began her journey.	Perfect participle.
13	**(b)** loss of mobility led to new freedom	Disability to possibilities.
14	**(b)** Authentic art can grow from respect and risk together	Balance.
15	**(d)** a metaphor that elevates a routine job	Elevation.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	She stresses mindset and choice (1) although physical training was also necessary, so both matter (1).	1+1
17	Secrecy shows fear and a lack of trust (1) but also protects her creative freedom until she is ready (1).	1+1
18	One life makes the idea concrete and moving (1) and represents many unseen workers (1).	1+1
19	It includes cost, sacrifice and change (1) so it tempers idealism with reality (1).	1+1
20	Possibilities look forward (1) while limits look at what is lacking (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	It can motivate (1). It can also oversimplify struggle (1). The text balances by showing effort and support (1).	1+1+1
22	Tradition holds identity (1). Innovation keeps it alive (1). Protection without growth leads to stagnation (1).	1+1+1
23	He keeps private news safe (1). He is honest with money (1). He serves without bias (1).	1+1+1
24	Sacrifice shows commitment (1). Not all success needs the same sacrifice (1). The letter stresses it as a typical cost (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is the goal (1). Crossing together redefines it (1). It becomes a line of unity (1).	1+1+1
25	He seeks excellence (1). He ties it to tradition (1). Both traits are present; perfectionism is the root (1).	1+1+1
	OR: His job is ordinary (1). His dedication makes it extraordinary (1). The text shows both (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks

26	Her illness (1). Her redefinition of life (1). Her work with sport and society (1). Avoiding the 'overcoming' narrative (1). Larger message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Conflict arises from differing music (1). It forces conversation (1). It leads to new understanding (1). The final music combines both (1). Conflict becomes harmony (1).	2+2+1
27	Khetaram's work (1). The postal service's reach (1). Trust built by service (1). Dignity of labour (1). Larger idea of public duty (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Hope begins the dream (1). Effort fulfils it (1). Sacrifice is the price (1). Support is the safety net (1). Flexibility keeps the contract fair (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 5–8: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals, Twin Melodies; A Friend Found in Music, Carrier of Words; Words (poem), Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** it assumes the dreamer has access to support and resources	Critique.
2	**(d)** choosing care over rank	Symbol.
3	**(b)** intergenerational dialogue	Dialogue.
4	**(c)** ethical, urging responsibility	Ethics.
5	**(d)** a belief that courage is a choice	Ethos.
6	**(c)** Never had she imagined such success.	Inversion after negative adverb.
7	**(a)** Hearing the tune, Nabin smiled.	Hearing...
8	**(a)** Neither the heat nor the distance stopped him.	Correct pairing.
9	**(a)** Mother said that had she known my plan, she would have helped.	Unreal past retained.
10	**(d)** they also challenge low expectations and need balanced support	Balanced view.
11	**(d)** shows change through experience, not argument	Show, don't tell.
12	**(b)** trust is built through consistent service	Trust.
13	**(a)** honest care	Honesty.
14	**(c)** to show society endorsing compassion	Social approval.
15	**(d)** an experience one can immerse in	Immersive.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	They provide a chorus of youth (1) and prompt Shruti to act (1).	1+1
17	Khetaram's labour is mostly unseen (1). The writer needs to remind us to respect it (1).	1+1
18	Clear structure and tone (1) with honest, kind content (1).	1+1
19	A medal becomes a sign of character (1) not of speed (1).	1+1
20	To keep the poem universal (1) so any reader can add their own music (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Simplicity reaches all (1). It matches direct action (1). It avoids obscuring the message (1).	1+1+1
22	Finishing (1). A gerund is a verb used as a noun (1). It is the subject of the sentence (1).	1+1+1
23	Shruti played a tune that was both old and new (1). 'That' joins the clauses (1). It avoids repetition (1).	1+1+1
24	Carrying a heavy bag, Khetaram trudged across the sand (1). Participle replaces a clause (1). Same subject (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Barely had she started when problems arose (1). Inversion after barely (1). It adds emphasis (1).	1+1+1
25	She acknowledges obstacles (1). She credits others (1). She links her success to wider change (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Nabin has dignity and reasons (1). He is loving (1). His change is gradual (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Competition drives excellence (1). Kindness adds humanity (1). Fair play includes care (1). Limits of the model (1). Balanced view (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Shruti posts a video (1). Nabin sees it (1). Mother mediates (1). Resolution (1).	2+2+1

27	Prose persuades by example (1). Poem by image and advice (1). Different tones (1). Both appeal to values (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Letter: explanation and advice (1). Poem: image and rhythm (1). Letter is personal (1). Poem is universal (1). Both aim at action (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 5–8: **The World of Limitless Possibilities; Nine Gold Medals, Twin Melodies; A Friend Found in Music, Carrier of Words; Words (poem), Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** A gentle word mended what the day had torn.	Healing.
2	**(c)** Avoid all challenges	Contradicts.
3	**(a)** Overcoming	Participial phrase.
4	**(b)** Leela suggested that they should hear her first.	Suggestion.
5	**(d)** Carrying a heavy bag	Phrase.
6	**(b)** persistence	Persistence.
7	**(b)** rejection of a deficit view	Reframing.
8	**(a)** his own history and the performance prepare the change	Prepared change.
9	**(a)** highlights real need for support and recognition	Balanced.
10	**(a)** dreams must be 'paid for' with effort	Metaphor.
11	**(a)** plain narrative and restraint	Restraint.
12	**(d)** ignores any drawbacks of music	One-sided.
13	**(b)** brief, sincere words can carry great meaning	Concision.
14	**(c)** failure gives experience that builds success	Learning.
15	**(c)** The runner who fell was helped by others.	Who fell.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	It can show respect or thought (1) and can give space for others (1).	1+1
17	Plain words reflect decisive action (1) and avoid excuses (1).	1+1
18	It focuses on achievements and choices (1) and uses empowering language (1).	1+1
19	She asks gentle, open questions (1) that lead him to see the pattern himself (1).	1+1
20	It shows quiet, hard service as essential (1) and deserving honour (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Plain description without exaggeration (1). Facts of hardship speak for themselves (1). The effect is dignity (1).	1+1+1
22	It acknowledges cost (1). It accepts change (1). It stresses support (1).	1+1+1
23	Simple vocabulary (1). Concrete images (1). The accumulation of small acts (1).	1+1+1
24	Respect lets each side speak (1). It permits learning (1). It ends in harmony (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Words hold power over people (1). Speakers choose to heal or harm (1). Power requires care (1).	1+1+1
25	Comfort as a room or trap (1). The challenge as a climb or door (1). Metaphors show the cost of staying (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Dr Malik won an individual medal, whereas the runners won as a group (1). 'Whereas' shows contrast (1). Both are kinds of victory (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Opening background (1). Questions on challenge (1). Questions on sport (1). Advice (1). Closing note of hope (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Shruti: innovation, hesitance (1). Nabin: tradition, certainty (1). Both disciplined (1). Their differences reveal each other (1). Resolution as balance (1).	2+2+1

27	Hardworking (1). Honest (1). Humble (1). Representative (1). Impact on the reader (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Warmth (1). Honesty (1). Practical advice (1). Respect for Ming's choice (1). Effect on the reader (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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